



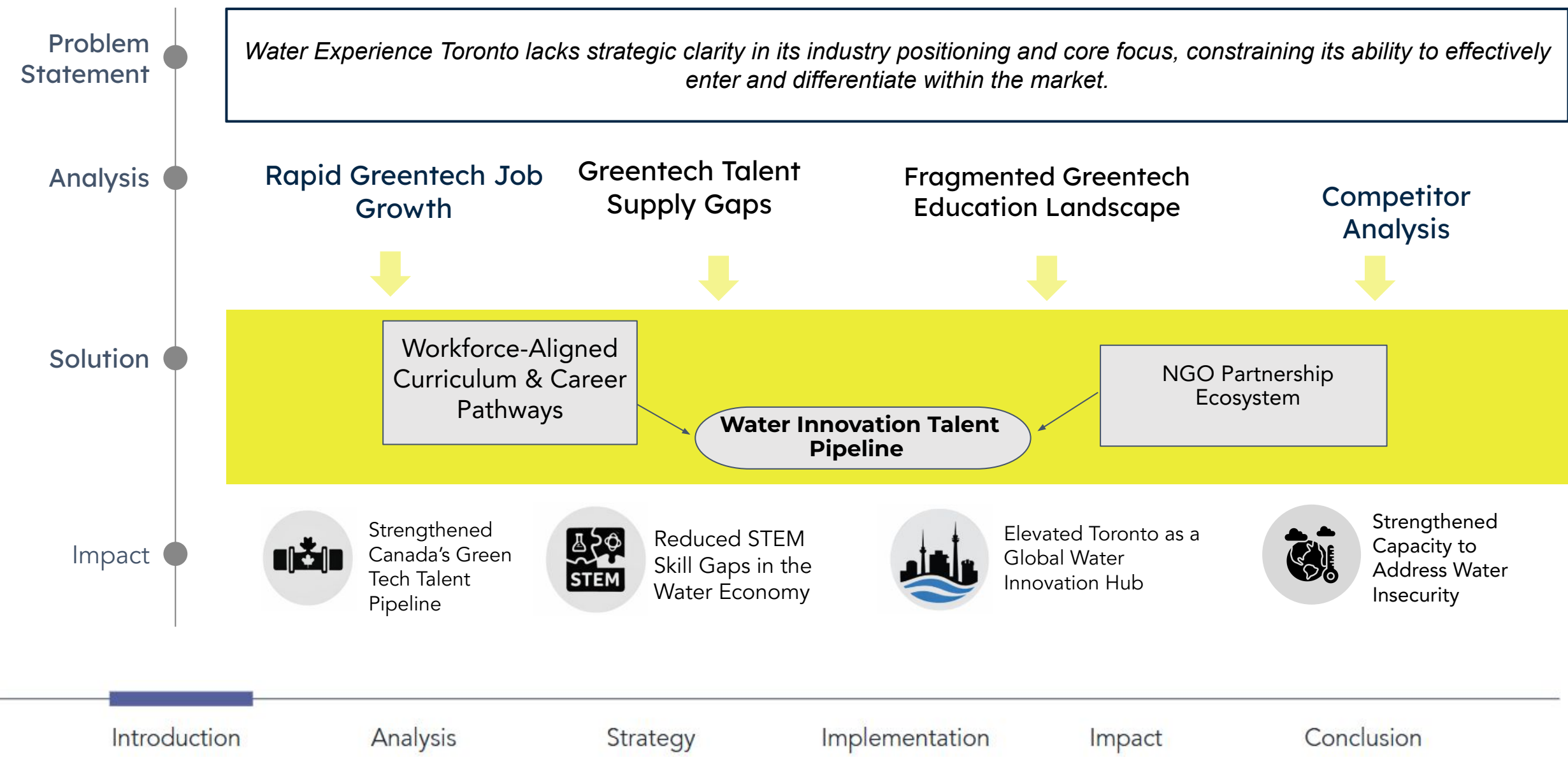
Water Experience Toronto

Inspiring the Next Generation of Water Leaders.

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Water Experience Toronto

Executive Summary



Demand Validation

Strong Local Demand for a Greentech Education Hub in Toronto

Market Size & Engagement

- *398k children 0–14 in Toronto (2021 census):
primary audience for school trips and family visits*
- *800+ youth engaged by City of Toronto in 2023–25 TransformTO Youth Climate process*
- *9M overnight visitors to Toronto in 2024, spending a record 8.8B*

Why This Matters

- Continuous pipeline of local school groups needing curriculum-linked STEM and climate excursions
- Youth explicitly asking City to invest in 'climate hubs':
 - physical spaces to gather, learn and take action
- Exhibition Place already draw large volumes of families and school groups; the centre adds an educational destination.
- Ability to serve both locals (school-year) and tourists (summer/CNE) smooths demand across seasons

Demand Validation

Demand Exists Across All Stakeholders: But No System Connects It

Demand Across All Stakeholders

Students & Youth

- STEM applications ↑ 34% since 2020
- Students prefer hands-on, real-world climate learning
- Only 9% say climate is discussed often in class

Parents & Public

- 62% say climate education should be a high priority
- 78% of Torontonians concerned about climate impacts
- Active parent networks pushing for more climate education

Government & Schools

- \$750M invested in STEM
- 20,500 new seats/year
- Strong demand for specialized STEM programs

System Cannot Deliver

Workforce Gap

- 1 in 3 employers can't find green-skilled workers
- Only ~1% of programs teach green skills

Education Gap

- Only 25% rate climate education highly
- Teachers lack time, resources, expertise

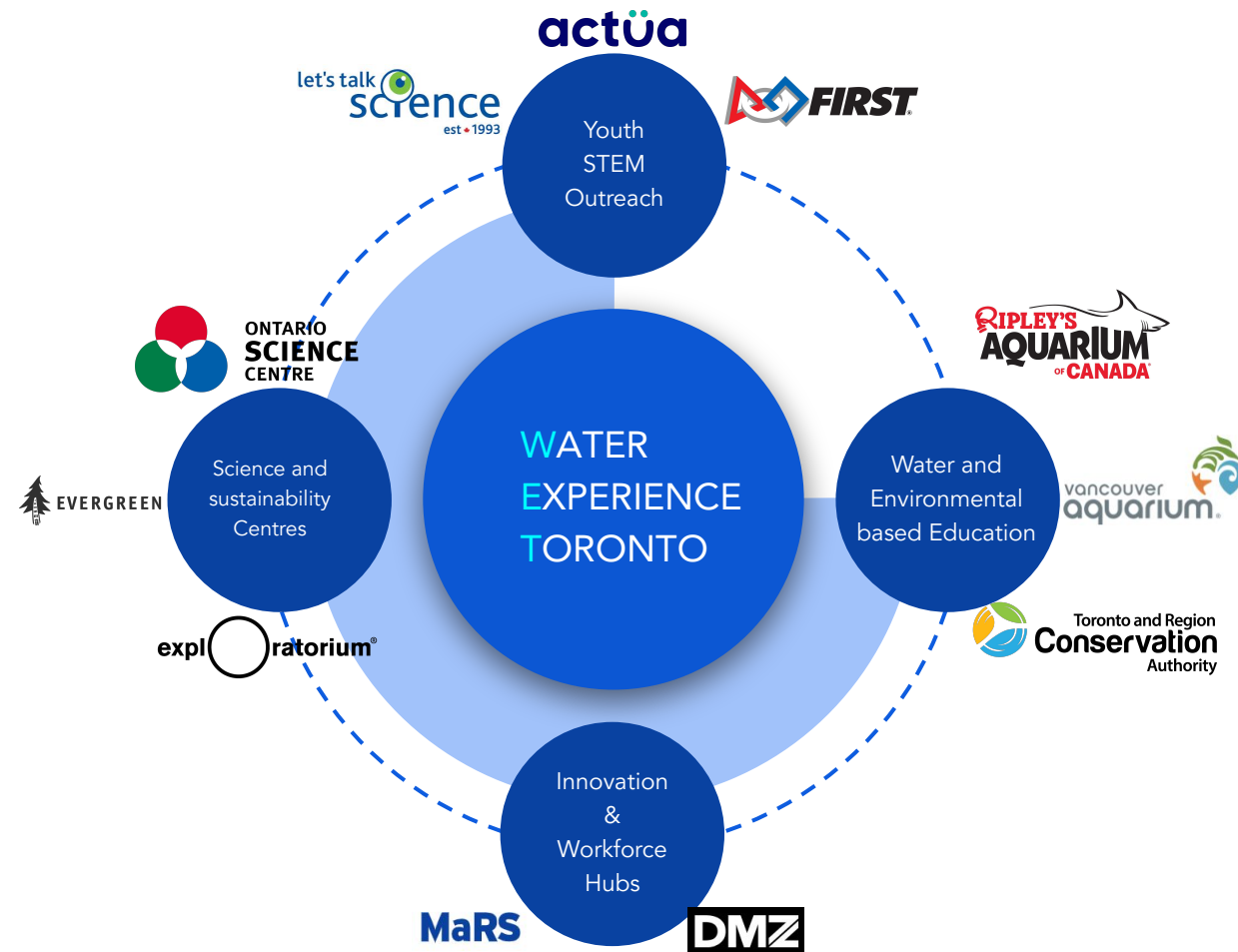
Water Opportunity

- ~50% of workforce retiring
- High demand for water & wastewater skills



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Competitor Analysis



WET does not face a single direct competitor.
Instead, it intersects with four adjacent ecosystems:

- ✓ Youth STEM Outreach Organizations
(Actua, Let's Talk Science, FIRST Robotics)
Strong in scale, but fragmented
- ✓ Science and sustainability Centres
(Ontario Science Centre, Exploratorium, Evergreen Brick Works)
Strong in engagement, but limited in long-term pathways.
- ✓ Water & Environmental Education Organizations
(Ripley's Aquarium, Vancouver Aquarium, TRCA)
Strong sustainability focus, but no structured pipelines.
- ✓ Innovation & Workforce Hubs
(MaRS, DMZ)
Strong industry alignment, but post-secondary focused.

Water Experience Toronto

Competitor Analysis - Scope

Across all six example organizations, engagement repeats; but never accumulates. None integrates infrastructure, specialization, multi-year pathways, and workforce outcomes.

Organization	Type	Example Programs	Strength	Key Limitation
	Youth STEM Outreach	Science Odyssey workshops; single-day innovation sprints; school visits	National scale, equity focus	No permanent home; episodic, no follow-on pathway
	Youth STEM Outreach	6–8 wk team prep; 1–3 day regional competition weekends	Project-based intensity; teamwork skills	Competition-bound learning; no environmental or water theme
	Youth STEM Outreach	Volunteer-led classroom visits; Saturday science events; single sessions	600+ partner sites; curriculum-aligned	Volunteer-driven; episodic; no longitudinal tracking
	Water / Environmental	Water Wonder (Gr 2); Oak Ridges Moraine (Gr 6–8); Clean Water, Clear Choices (Gr 8); Virtual Water (Gr 9–12)	Water-focused; place-based; TDSB relationships	Resets annually; no multi-year track; no career pathway
	Water / Environmental	Guided school tours (half-day); holiday youth camps (1–3 days); Marine Teens volunteer program	Water identity; high brand recognition	Single-visit model; no curriculum progression; no greentech
	Sustainability Centre	Nature School (Fridays, 8-wk sessions, ages 6–10, \$600/session); seasonal family workshops	Proves place-based model works in Toronto	Not STEM/tech-oriented; no structured pathway; no careers

1

Permanent Infrastructure

A dedicated facility at Exhibition Place instead of a borrowed space. A home that builds identity, community, and continuity.

2

Water-Focused Specialization

The only pre-secondary institution in Canada anchored entirely in water technology and greentech, not generic STEM.

3

Multi-Year Structured Pathways

A progressive curriculum from Grade 4 to Grade 12 with skill certificates at each level → a journey, not a visit.

4

Direct Workforce Pipeline

Co-ops, internships, and mentorships with Stantec, AECOM, and WaterTAP connect students from age 6 to first job.

What Competitors Offer vs What WET Delivers		
A moment of exposure	→	A decade-long pathway
Borrowed spaces	→	Permanent centre on the waterfront
Generic STEM	→	Water + greentech specialization
Annual program reset	→	Progressive Gr 4–12 curriculum
Engagement ends at engagement	→	Engagement starts the pipeline
WET is not entering a crowded market: it is entering an incomplete one. Permanent infrastructure + water specialization + structured pathways + workforce pipeline: no other Canadian organization integrates all four.		

Problem Breakdown

Analyzing what needs to be focused on before development

1

Unclear Industry Positioning

- WET sits between STEM education, sustainability centres, and workforce hubs
- No defined category leadership
- Hard for partners, schools, and funders to understand its core value

2

Fragmented Greentech Education Landscape

- Existing organizations provide short-term or single-visit programs
- Engagement does not accumulate into long-term learning pathways
- No integrated infrastructure connecting education → skills → careers

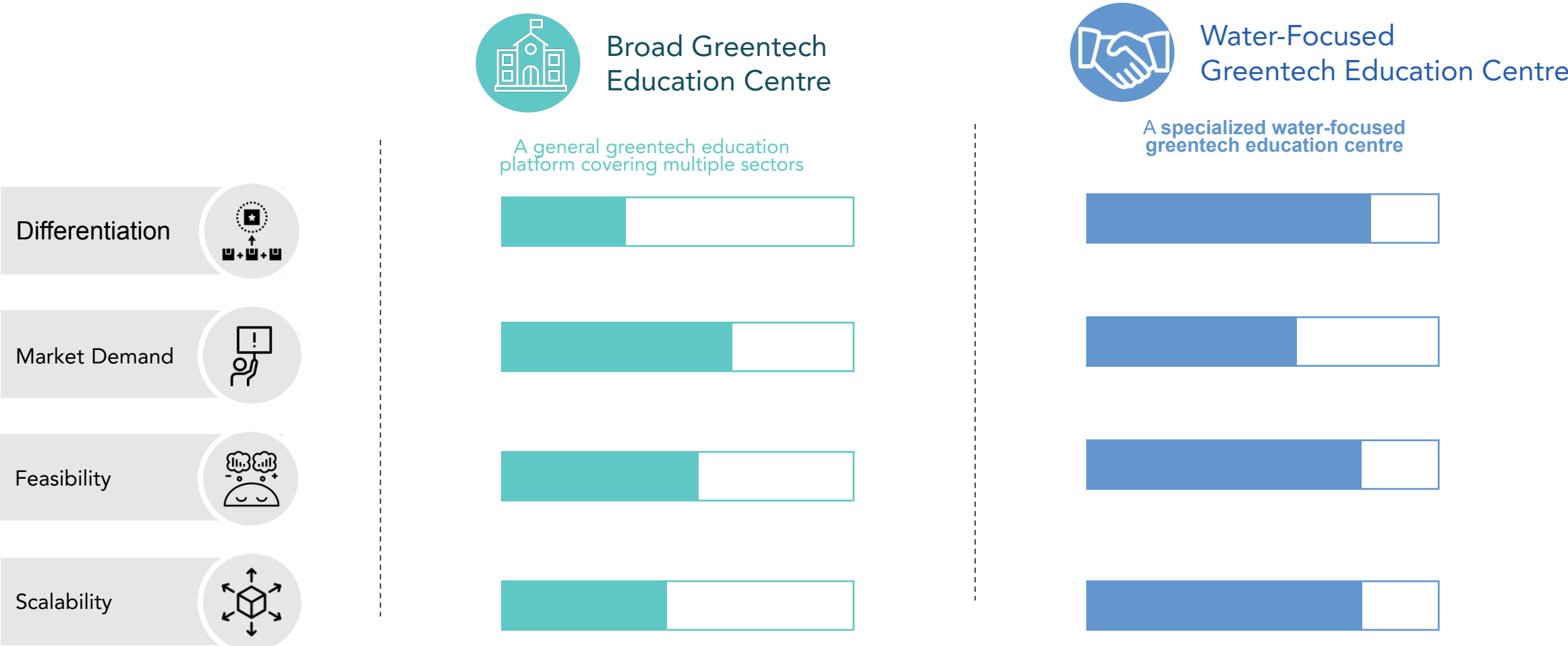
3

Weak Differentiation Strategy

- Broad greentech education overlaps with many players
- Without specialization, WET risks becoming another STEM outreach program
- Strategic focus is needed to create a defensible niche

Comparing Solutions

Decision Matrix



Comparing Solutions

Decision Matrix

Differentiation

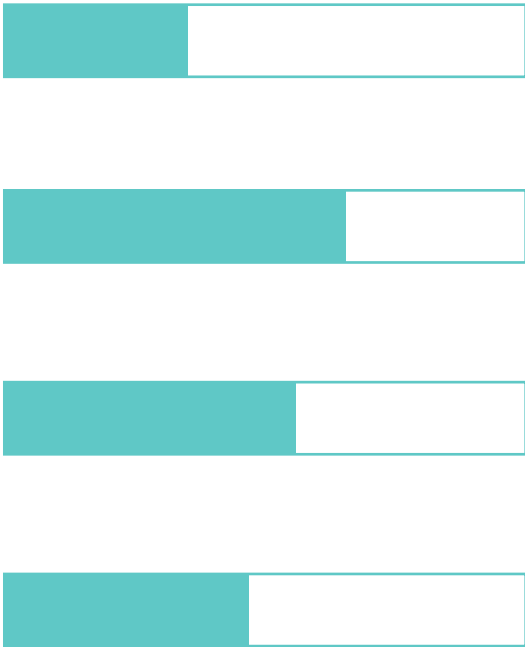
Market Demand

Feasibility

Scalability

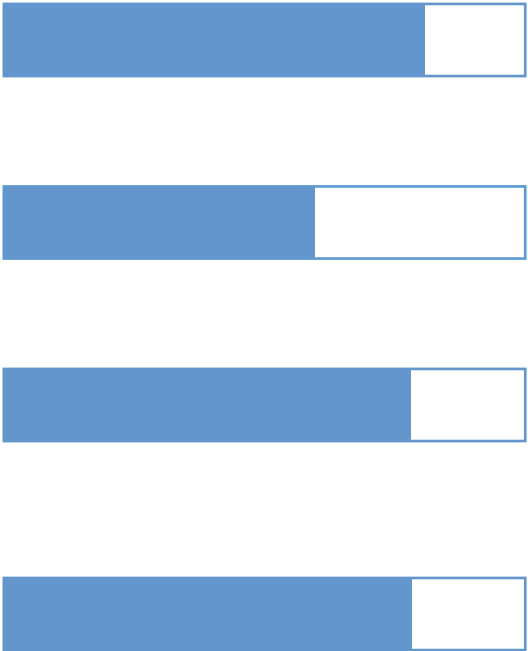
Broad Greentech Education Centre

A general greentech education platform covering multiple sectors



Water-Focused Greentech Education Centre

A specialized water-focused greentech education centre



Broad Greentech Education Centre

Strategy #1: Year-round hub for youth climate and greentech learning across energy, water, waste, food, and mobility.



NGO Partnerships



Potential Programs



Water-Focused Greentech Education Centre

Strategy #2: Water-focused talent pipeline for youth greentech education



NGO Partnerships



WORKSHOPS



Program Collaborations

Implementation: Curriculum Development Strategy

WET combines curriculum standards with industry expertise to create applied STEM learning tied to real greentech careers.

WET will build a career-connected greentech curriculum by leveraging existing STEM frameworks and industry expertise

Build on existing frameworks

- Complement the **Ontario STEM curriculum** and environmental education standards
- Focus modules around **water technology and greentech careers**

Hands-on learning modules

Examples of program themes:

- Water treatment & purification
- Environmental monitoring systems
- Smart water infrastructure
- Climate resilience & sustainability

Outcome-based learning

Each module includes a **tangible output**

- experiment
- prototype
- data analysis project

Industry volunteer educators

- Engineers and environmental specialists
- Corporate guest lectures and workshops

University partnerships

- STEM students and graduate researchers as mentors
- Strengthens talent pipeline exposure

Program delivery

- Weekend and after-school programs initially
- Expands into **full curriculum pathway (ages 6–16)**



Access + Program Delivery Channel



Expertise

Program Format

- **Weekend-based program (4–6 weeks)**
- Target: **Elementary & middle school students**
- Delivered through:
 - Community hubs
 - Existing NGO programs

Key Activities

- Hands-on water & greentech projects
- Group-based learning
- Real-world problem solving

Impact Measurement

- Student engagement & participation
- Learning outcomes
- Feedback from students & parents

Final Showcase



- Hands-on water & greentech projects
- Group-based learning
- Real-world problem solving

Pilot Program

School Collaboration

Building on Phase 1 pilot data, expanding from NGO partners to school partnerships to generate curriculum impact evidence at scale

School Partnership Strategy	What This Phase Looks Like	Data We Generate
- Target TDSB and TCDSB elementary and secondary schools in Priority Neighbourhoods - Offer curriculum-linked field programs (water cycle, filtration, sustainability) aligned with Ontario Science curriculum - Provide teacher professional development sessions at WET to build relationships - Co-develop in-class pre/post visit materials so WET extends beyond the field trip - Leverage TRCA's existing school network as a warm introduction channel	4-8 week structured school cohort programs, after school + during school hours - Age-differentiated tracks: Gr 4-6 (water literacy), Gr 7-8 (water systems + design), Gr 9-12 (applied greentech) - Industry guest instructors from WaterTAP/Stantec begin joining as regular contributors - Students complete a hands-on capstone project (e.g. water filtration design challenge) - Classes return in subsequent terms, creating multi-visit rather than single-visit relationships	- Pre/post assessments measuring water literacy and STEM skill gains - Student engagement and participation rates per school - Teacher satisfaction and curriculum relevance scores - Number of schools returning for repeat visits (retention signal) - Qualitative: student testimonials and teacher endorsements for funding pitch to government

Introduction

Analysis

Strategy

Implementation

Impact

Conclusion

Impact

Solving the Strategic Gap

By adopting a water-focused greentech positioning and a partnership-driven go-to-market strategy, WET can overcome its lack of strategic clarity and successfully enter the market.



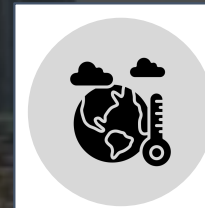
Strengthened
Canada's Green
Tech Talent
Pipeline



Elevated Toronto as a
Global Water
Innovation Hub



Reduced STEM
Skill Gaps in the
Water Economy



Strengthened
Capacity to
Address Water
Insecurity

Implementation Plan



1

Phase 1

Entry Programs

- ✓ Secure 2–3 NGO partners
- ✓ Launch weekend workshops (20–30 students/cohort)
- ✓ Validate curriculum + collect impact data
- ✓ Pilot at NGO/community facilities

→ Proof of concept



2

Phase 2

School Collaboration

- ✓ Partner with TDSB Priority schools
- ✓ Launch 4–8 week school cohort programs
- ✓ Integrate industry guest instructors
- ✓ Generate curriculum impact data for funders

→ Institutional credibility



3

Phase 3

Permanent Centre Opens

- ✓ Secure space at Exhibition Place (Better Living Centre)
- ✓ Launch Gr 4–12 multi-year curriculum tracks
- ✓ Certificates by skill area; mentorship matching
- ✓ Corporate partner lab sponsorships

→ Structural pipeline



4

Phase 4

Workforce Pipeline

- ✓ Gr 10–12 co-op + internship placements
- ✓ Employer sourcing channel (Stantec, AECOM, WaterTAP)
- ✓ Post-secondary bridging credentials
- ✓ Alumni network established

→ Age 6 → first job

Introduction

Analysis

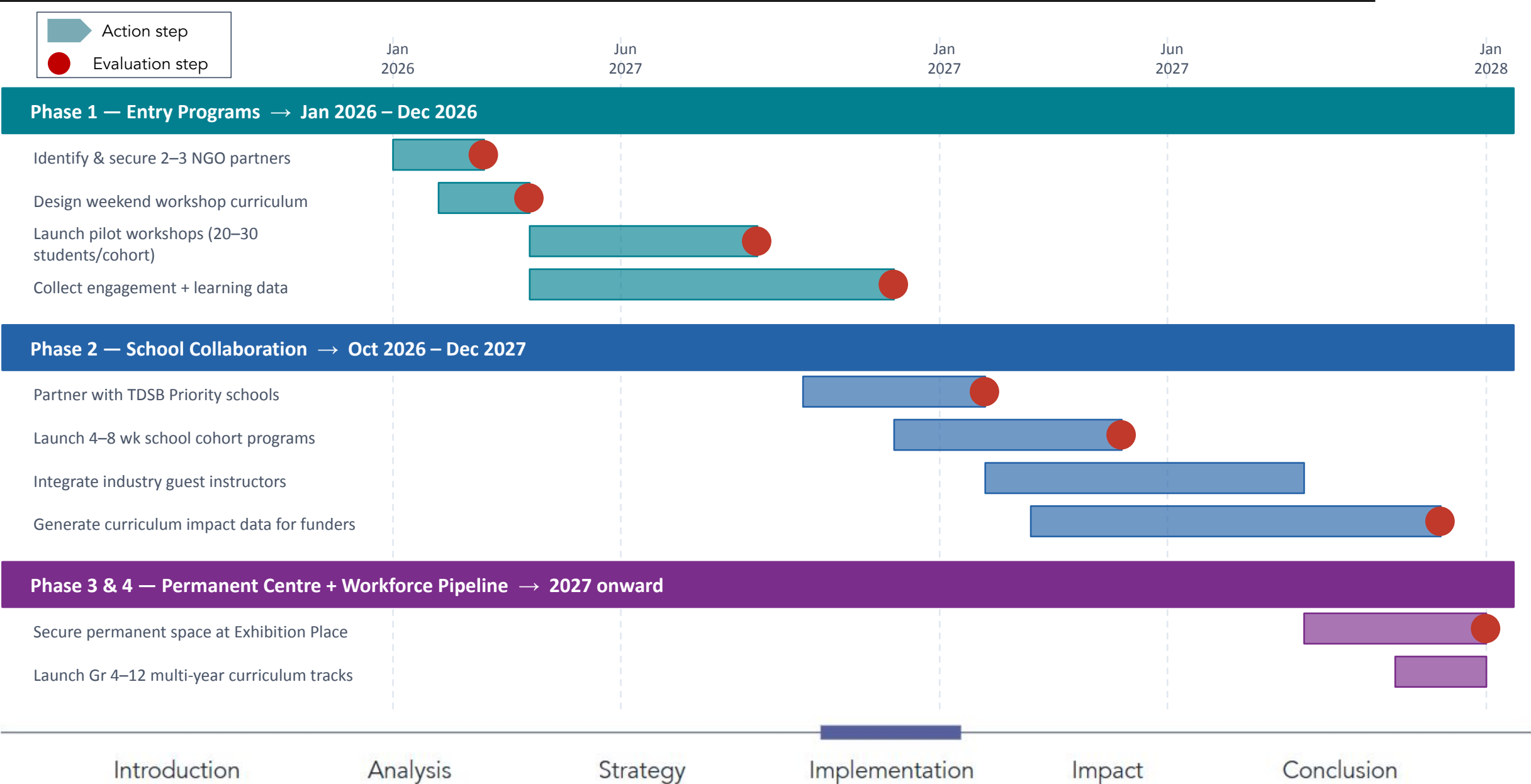
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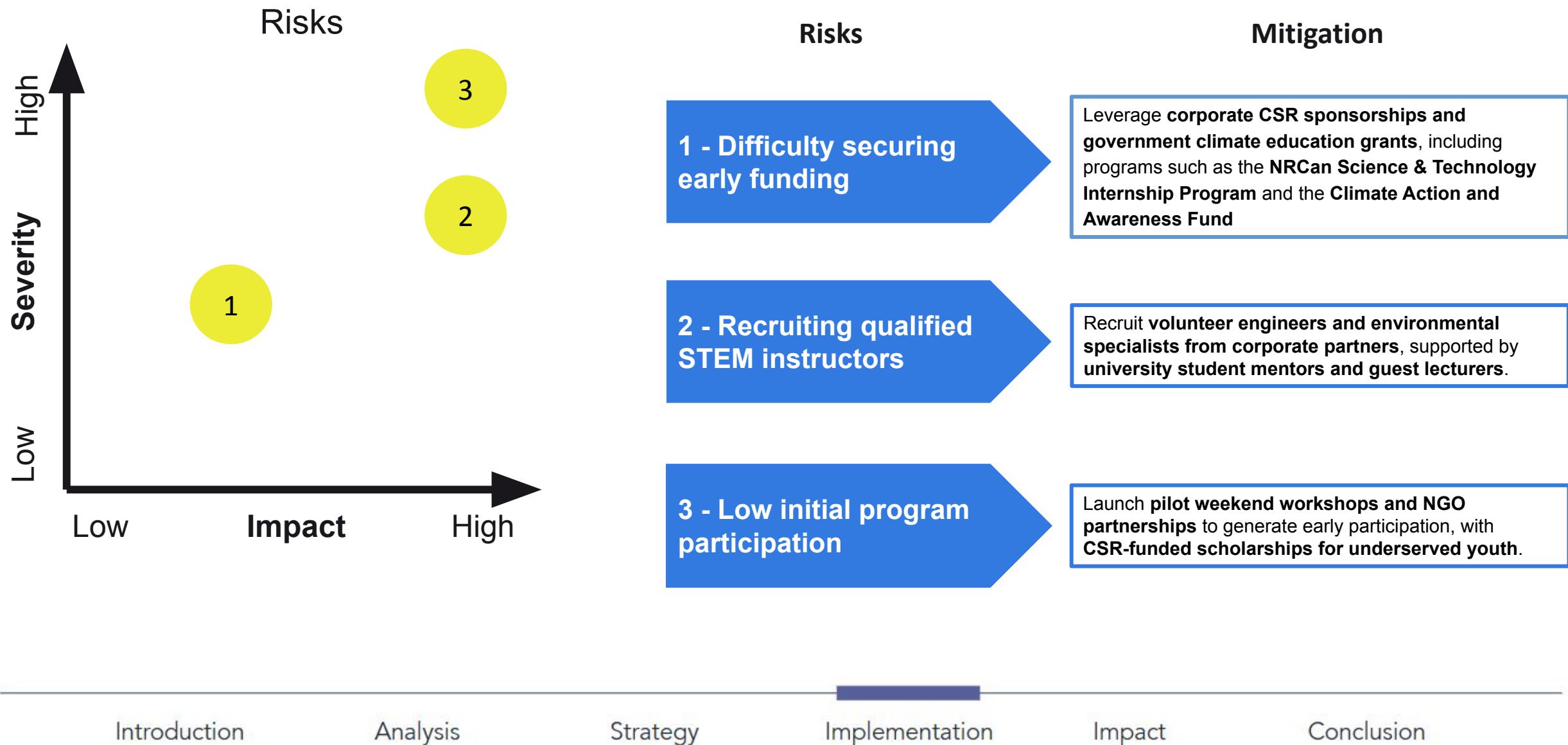
Conclusion

Implementation Plan



Risk & Mitigation

Strategic partnerships with industry and government reduce implementation risk while enabling scalable program growth.



Conclusion



A hand-drawn illustration of a sustainable city. In the foreground, a hand holds a green pen, drawing on a surface. The scene features several glowing lightbulbs, some of which are integrated into the architecture of tall, green buildings. The background is a dark, starry sky with various geometric shapes and patterns. The overall theme is innovation and sustainability.

Thank You!

Any Questions?